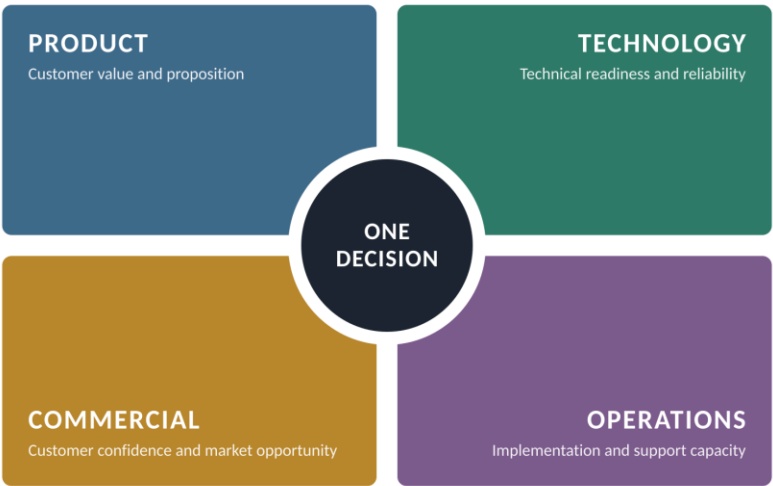


FACILITATOR GUIDE

The Launch Decision

One business. Four perspectives. One decision.



Experience	A half-day cross-functional collaboration experience
Client	A well-known technology company
Participants	25 senior managers
Duration	3 hours 45 minutes, including one 10-minute break
Document	Session design, run of show and all participant materials

Different perspectives are not the problem. A fragmented picture is.

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Sections 01–05 explain why the session is designed the way it is. Read them once, well before the day.

Sections 06–13 are the operating manual. Each segment carries its timing, slide numbers, facilitator moves and the lines worth saying word for word.

Sections 14–16 and the appendices are for preparation and printing. Slide numbers refer to *Unbox_The_Launch_Decision_Facilitator_Presentation*.

SECTION 01

Session Snapshot

Client	A well-known technology company
Participants	25 senior managers drawn from across functions
Duration	Half-day: 3 hours 45 minutes, including a 10-minute break
Core experience	<i>The Launch Decision</i> : a facilitated, two-round cross-functional decision simulation
Group structure	Four functional perspectives of six or seven participants (6 · 6 · 6 · 7)
Behavioural framework	SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN
Participants leave with	One real cross-functional situation examined with a peer, and one specific, observable commitment
Facilitation	One lead facilitator. A co-facilitator is recommended to hold time and capture observations, leaving the lead free to watch the system

THE IDEA IN ONE LINE

Different perspectives are not the problem. A fragmented picture is.

Cross-functional collaboration is not about removing differences between functions. It is about making those differences useful.

SECTION 02

Business Context & Design Challenge

The brief

Cross-functional collaboration has become difficult. Departments are operating in silos, and poor communication and coordination recently contributed to a major project-delivery setback. The organisation has asked for a half-day experience for 25 senior managers that strengthens how they work across functions.

How we have read the problem

The instinctive response to a delivery setback is to ask functions to communicate more. Our reading is narrower, and more useful to design around: senior leaders often do not lack information; they lack a shared picture of the problem.

Each function holds legitimate information, reads it through its own priorities and fills the gaps with assumptions. Decisions are then made on a picture that no single function can see in full. Nobody is behaving badly. The picture is simply fragmented.

That reading shapes three commitments in the design:

- **Differences are material, not a fault.** Functional expertise and functional advocacy are valuable. Disagreement is not automatically a collaboration failure. The problem starts when perspectives remain partial.
- **Experience before explanation.** Senior managers have seen collaboration models before. They need to feel what a fragmented picture does to a decision, then name the behaviours themselves.
- **Practise, then transfer.** Leaders get two attempts at the same decision and one real workplace situation to apply the behaviours to.

DESIGN CHALLENGE

How might we help 25 senior managers experience what happens when capable functions decide with a partial picture, and practise the behaviours that turn different perspectives into a shared decision they can own?

What the session is designed to do

- Enhance cross-functional collaboration.
- Create opportunities to practise behaviours that can strengthen working trust.
- Help leaders recognise the effect of incomplete information, assumptions and functional priorities on collective decision-making.
- Help participants move from functional perspectives toward a shared organisational picture.

What we will not claim

An afternoon does not build trust. Trust is strengthened through repeated workplace interactions. The accurate claim, and the one to use in the room, is that *the experience creates opportunities to practise behaviours that can strengthen working trust.*

Handling the real setback

The simulation uses a fictional company and product. That distance is deliberate: leaders can examine their own patterns without relitigating a real project in front of peers. The real work returns in My Silo Moment, on each participant's own terms. Acknowledge the business context once in the opening and do not reopen the setback.

SECTION 03

Learning Objectives

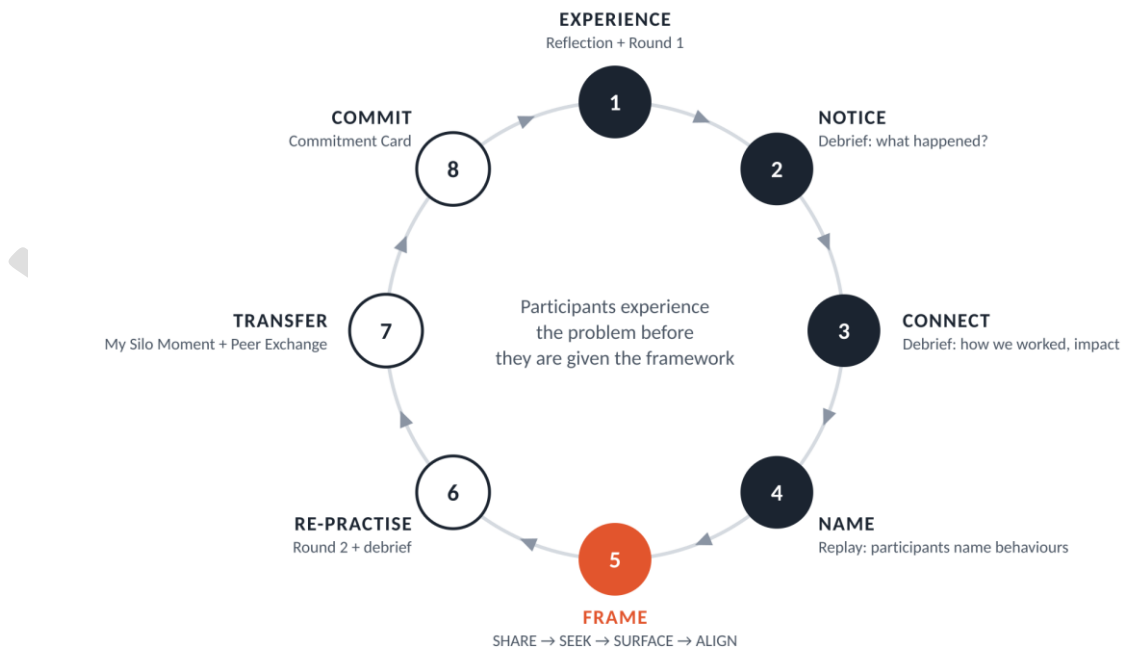
By the end of the session, participants should be able to:

#	Objective	Where it happens
1	Recognise how incomplete or distributed information, functional priorities and assumptions can create cross-functional friction.	Round 1 and Round 1 Debrief
2	Identify behaviours that strengthen cross-functional collaboration and working trust.	Replay question and Framework
3	Practise SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN in collaborative decision-making.	Framework Practice and Round 2
4	Apply those behaviours to a real cross-functional workplace challenge.	My Silo Moment and Peer Exchange
5	Commit to one specific, observable behavioural change.	Commitment

SECTION 04

Experience Design

The session follows one arc. Participants experience the problem before they are taught the framework, so that when the framework arrives it names something they have already felt and already started to articulate.



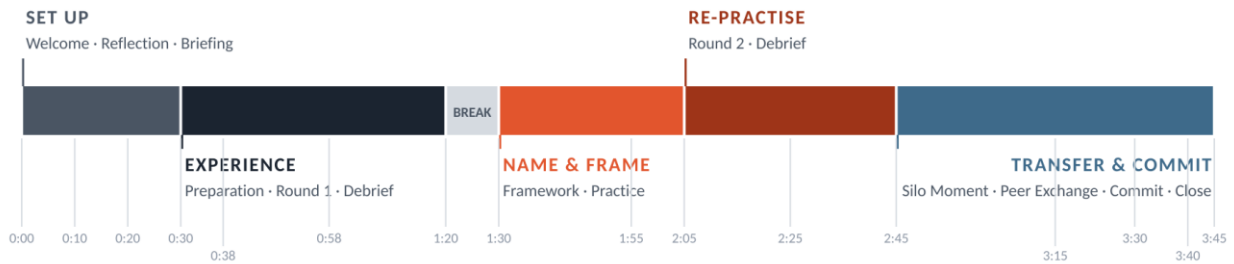
Stage	Session moment	What participants do
Experience	Cross-Functional Reflection · Round 1	Recall real partial pictures; then decide as four functions with distributed information
Notice	Round 1 Debrief: What happened?	Reconstruct what they knew, what they lacked and when things changed
Connect	Debrief: How did we work? What was the impact?	Link their own behaviour to the quality and speed of the decision
Name	Replay	Generate, in their own words, what they would do differently
Frame	Framework · Framework Practice	See their behaviours named as SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN
Re-practise	Round 2 · Round 2 Debrief	Use the behaviours deliberately under changed conditions
Transfer	My Silo Moment · Peer Exchange	Apply the lens to a live workplace situation with a peer
Commit	Commitment	Choose one specific, observable behaviour to try next

Design principles

Principle	How it shows up
Audience-centred	Built around the real challenge these senior managers face: making decisions across functions with incomplete information. No abstract team games.
Experiential	Participants meet the problem first. The debrief creates the need for the framework before it is shown.
Purposeful gamification	The engagement comes from the mechanics: distributed information, multiple perspectives, time pressure, decision-making, trade-offs, changing conditions, consequences and re-practice. There are no points, badges, leaderboards or competition between groups.
Design thinking	Demonstrated through the structure rather than taught as a module: understanding participant context, framing the real problem, designing around behaviour, testing behaviours in Round 2 and transferring them to a real situation.
Systems thinking	Product + Technology + Commercial + Operations = one interconnected system. Participants discover the dependencies for themselves. The facilitator does not lecture on them.

SECTION 05

Session Architecture



Time	Experience	Min	Mode	Slides
0:00–0:10	Welcome & Context	10	Plenary	1–3
0:10–0:20	Cross-Functional Reflection	10	Mixed trios	4
0:20–0:30	Simulation Briefing	10	Plenary	5–7
0:30–0:38	Function Preparation	8	Function groups	8
0:38–0:58	Round 1	20	One decision room	9–10
0:58–1:20	Round 1 Debrief	22	Plenary	11–14
1:20–1:30	Break	10	—	15
1:30–1:55	Framework	25	Plenary	16–17
1:55–2:05	Framework Practice	10	Function groups	18
2:05–2:25	Round 2	20	One decision room	19–20
2:25–2:45	Round 2 Debrief	20	Plenary	21
2:45–3:15	My Silo Moment	30	Individual	22
3:15–3:30	Peer Exchange	15	Pairs	23
3:30–3:40	Commitment	10	Individual → plenary	24
3:40–3:45	Close	5	Plenary	25

Total: approximately 3 hours 45 minutes. Times run from the scheduled start (0:00).

PROTECT THE STRUCTURE

This is the approved half-day architecture. Do not add activities to fill time. If a segment finishes early, go deeper in the next debrief, not wider.

Facilitator Run of Show

The full session on one page, followed by the detail for the opening 30 minutes. Sections 08–13 carry the detail for everything from Function Preparation onward.

Time	Segment	Slides	Mode	Facilitator focus
0:00–0:10	Welcome & Context	1–3	Plenary	Open with the question; do not answer it. Establish a practice space.
0:10–0:20	Cross-Functional Reflection	4	Mixed trios	Connect to lived experience of partial pictures. Hear it; don't fix it.
0:20–0:30	Simulation Briefing	5–7	Plenary	Common brief, four perspectives, role statement, options and questions.
0:30–0:38	Function Preparation	8	Function groups	Hand out function briefs. Circulate. Do not coach content.
0:38–0:58	Round 1	9–10	One decision room	Observe the system. Call time. Do not steer.
0:58–1:20	Round 1 Debrief	11–14	Plenary	What happened → how we worked → impact → replay. Capture their words.
1:20–1:30	Break	15	—	Cluster the replay flipchart into four unlabelled groups.
1:30–1:55	Framework	16–17	Plenary	Name what they generated. Link each behaviour to a Round 1 moment.
1:55–2:05	Framework Practice	18	Function groups	One specific item per behaviour.
2:05–2:25	Round 2	19–20	One decision room	Read the event card. Framework in deliberate use.
2:25–2:45	Round 2 Debrief	21	Plenary	What was different? Did the framework guarantee agreement?
2:45–3:15	My Silo Moment	22	Individual	A real situation. Their own assumptions, not other people's.
3:15–3:30	Peer Exchange	23	Pairs	Don't solve it. Help them see it.
3:30–3:40	Commitment	24	Individual → plenary	Specific and observable. Test it.
3:40–3:45	Close	25	Plenary	Return to the opening question. Closing lines, word for word.

Purpose. Frame the afternoon with a question rather than an answer, and establish the room as a practice space.

- Have slide 1 on screen as people arrive. Open on slide 2 with no preamble. Read the question and let it sit.
- Take two or three responses. Do not summarise or explain them. Close with: “Hold that. We’ll come back to it.”
- Acknowledge the business context in one sentence, then move on.
- Slide 3: how the session works. Three principles, then a quick look at the shape of the day.

SAY

“What happens when smart people, working toward the same business outcome, don’t have the same picture?”

“Working across functions has become harder than it should be here, and it has had a cost. We’re not going to relitigate any project today. We’re going to look at how decisions get made across functions: first in a simulation, then in your own work.”

“There’s no right answer to find today, and nothing here is assessed. This is a practice space.”

DESIGN INTENT

Participants should experience incomplete information before being taught how to manage it. The opening question is deliberately left open; it is answered in the close, three and a half hours later.

Purpose. Connect participants to their own experience of partial pictures, and mix the room before the simulation begins.

- Ask people to form trios with colleagues from different functions and, where possible, different reporting lines.
- One minute of quiet thought, seven minutes in trios, two minutes to hear two or three observations in the room.
- Prompts (slide 4): *Think of a recent decision that needed more than one function. What did your function see clearly? What did you only learn later, and from whom?*
- Capture short phrases on a flipchart. Do not categorise or interpret them yet.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Expect some “they never tell us”. Let it be heard without correcting it. Keep the phrases visible: that language is useful material when the room reflects on Round 1.

Purpose. Give everyone the same starting picture, assign perspectives and make the task unambiguous.

- Distribute the Common Participant Brief (Appendix A) to everyone.
- Slide 5: introduce NexaTech and NexaFlow. Deliver the scenario plainly; do not signal that anything is wrong.
- Slide 6: introduce the four perspectives. Groups are pre-assigned; point people to their function areas. Deliver the role statement word for word.
- Slide 7: the four options and the four decision questions. There is no predetermined correct answer.
- Check the task with one question: “What will you hand me at the end of Round 1?” (One collective recommendation on the decision sheet, with the four questions answered.)

SAY

“For this simulation, you are temporarily representing a functional perspective. You are not expected to behave according to your actual job function.”

“Each function has part of the picture. There is no predetermined correct answer.”

The Launch Decision: Simulation Mechanics

One business. Four perspectives. One decision.

The scenario

NexaTech is preparing to launch **NexaFlow**, a new technology solution designed to help large organisations manage and automate high-volume internal processes.

Launch is scheduled six weeks from now	It is strategically important
Significant investment has already been made	Early customer interest is strong
The project is officially considered on track	Different functions see different readiness signals

Four perspectives

Participants are temporarily placed into functional perspectives. They do not need to belong to those functions in real life. Full briefs are in Appendices A.1–A.4.

Function	Lens	Protecting	Needs clarity on
Product	Customer value and proposition	Customer value and the credibility of the product proposition	What can realistically be delivered; technical and operational implications; what a phased or reduced launch means for customers; what commitments the organisation can confidently support
Technology	Technical readiness and reliability	Reliability and technical readiness	Expected customer volume; rollout pattern; whether controlled rollout is commercially acceptable; what level of risk the organisation is prepared to accept
Commercial	Customer confidence and market opportunity	Customer confidence, market momentum and commercial opportunity	What “ready” means across the organisation; whether staged introduction is commercially workable; what customers would experience under different options; which risks can be actively managed
Operations	Implementation and support capacity	Implementation quality, support capacity and organisational readiness	Likely initial customer volume; rollout pattern; customer support expectations; risks the organisation is prepared to accept

The decision

The whole group makes one collective recommendation from four options:

Launch as planned	Phase the launch	Reduce initial scope	Delay the launch
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And must explain:

- What are we protecting?
- What are we willing to compromise?
- What is the biggest risk we are accepting?
- What needs to happen next?

THE PRINCIPLE THAT HOLDS THE SIMULATION TOGETHER

Every functional perspective must remain legitimate, and the decision should become clearer—not necessarily easier—when information is shared.

No function is “the problem”. No function holds the obvious answer. The tension is productive, not artificial: participants can only improve the quality of their decision by understanding the other perspectives.

How information is distributed

Everyone receives the Common Participant Brief. Each function then receives only its own Function Brief. This is not secrecy, and there are no “secret” cards: it mirrors how functional information actually sits in organisations. Nobody is told to hide anything, and nobody is told to share everything. The learning comes from what participants choose to share, seek and integrate.

If a participant asks whether they are allowed to share their brief, answer: *“Nothing in your brief is confidential. What you share, and when, is your call.”*

Where the picture connects (facilitator reference only)

Every function is asking a question another function can help answer. These are the dependency threads participants are meant to discover. Do not point them out during Round 1; use them in the debrief.

Thread	Who needs it	Where it sits
Likely initial customer volume	Technology, Operations	In no single brief. Commercial (customer interest) and Product (early-customer research) hold the closest signals. It has to be built between functions.
Rollout pattern	Technology, Operations	Depends on whether staged introduction is commercially workable (Commercial) and what a phased launch means for customers (Product).
What “ready” means	Commercial asks it outright	Each other function defines readiness differently: proposition (Product), reliability (Technology), capacity (Operations).
Risk the organisation will accept	Technology, Operations, Commercial	No function owns it. Only the collective decision can.

Tension map (facilitator reference only)

How each option pulls on each perspective, drawn only from the briefs. Every option protects something and costs something elsewhere. That is the point.

	Product	Technology	Commercial	Operations
Launch as planned	Both priority capabilities delivered on the planned date	Full-scale exposure before the complete fix is available	Momentum and the strategic customer's plans protected; a poor early experience would put confidence at risk	Projected full volume would stretch implementation and support
Phase the launch	Depends on what customers experience in the first phase	Controlled rollout lowers exposure while the fix is completed	Workable only if staged introduction is commercially acceptable: an open question	Manageable; time to build capacity and learn from early implementations
Reduce initial scope	Simplifies delivery; could weaken the proposition if the two priority capabilities are limited	The briefs do not say that scope reduction addresses the high-volume issue	Something arrives on time, though perhaps not what drew the strongest interest	The Operations brief is framed around volume rather than scope
Delay the launch	Proposition preserved, but later	Time for the full technical fix	A significant delay could affect confidence and momentum; expectations exist, though not contractually	Time to build capacity

IF A GROUP FINDS A CLEAN ANSWER

No row is clean. If a group tells you an option has no meaningful downside, ask: "What assumption is your decision relying on?"

Function Preparation & Round 1

0:30–0:38

Function Preparation

Slide 8 · Function groups · 8 min

Purpose. Each function builds its own view before entering the shared room, so that perspectives arrive fully formed and genuinely different.

- Groups move to their function areas. Give each participant their Function Brief (Appendices A.1–A.4) and each group one Function Preparation Sheet (Appendix B).
- Show slide 8. Start a timer the whole room can see.
- Circulate and listen. Do not coach content. If a group asks what the “right” position is, turn it back: “What is your function protecting?”
- At two minutes remaining: “Two minutes. Be ready to bring your perspective into one room.”

The six preparation questions:

What is our function responsible for?	What are we protecting?
What concerns us most?	What information do we have that others may need?
What do we need to understand from the other functions?	What would we initially recommend?

DESIGN INTENT

Do not tell groups to hide information and do not tell them to share it. The information is legitimate functional information. What they choose to do with it is the experience.

0:38–0:58

Round 1

Slides 9–10 · One decision room · 20 min

Purpose. Four functions make one decision together with a distributed picture, under time pressure.

Set-up

- Bring everyone into the central decision space. Place the Round 1 Decision Sheet (Appendix C, A3) and its flipchart version in the centre.
- Show slide 9 and start the 20-minute timer.

SAY

“Four functions. One room. Twenty minutes. One recommendation the organisation can own.”

During the round

- Step back and observe the system, not individual personalities. Use the Facilitator Observation Sheet (Appendix J). Capture at least three specific moments with a time and the exact words used.
- Call time at 10, 5 and 1 minutes remaining. At 5 minutes, switch to slide 10 (Decision check).

- Do not steer toward an option. If someone asks you a content question another function could answer, redirect: “Who in the room might know that?”
- Do not suggest a structure: no chair, no spokespeople, no round-robin. How the room organises itself is part of the learning.
- At 20:00, stop. Collect the decision sheet. If there is no decision: “Record where you are. An unfinished decision is data too.”

FACILITATOR WATCH-FOR

Functional advocacy is useful. Do not shut it down too early; use it as material for the debrief.

DO NOT RESCUE

Productive friction is part of the learning experience. If the room stalls, wait longer than feels comfortable before using a contingency question (Section 15).

What to observe

Dimension	Look for
Information exchange	When does each function first offer what it knows? What never gets said?
Questioning	Are questions asked to understand, or to win a point?
Advocacy	Which positions are argued hardest, and on what basis?
Assumptions	Where does someone state as fact something no brief says?
Risk surfacing	When is the high-volume performance issue first mentioned, and by whom?
Dependencies	Does anyone connect customer volume, rollout pattern and support capacity?
Shared-outcome thinking	Does the language move from “we need” to “the organisation needs”?
Decision ownership	Could all four functions explain why the decision is one they can own?

Round 1 Debrief

0:58–1:20

Round 1 Debrief

Slides 11–14 · Plenary · 22 min

Purpose. Turn the experience into insight, and let participants generate the behaviours before any framework is shown. The debrief is placed before the framework deliberately: participants need to feel the gap before they are offered a way to close it.

Time	Movement	Questions
0:58–1:01	The decision on the record	One voice reads the recommendation and the four answers. No evaluation. “Thank you. We’ll come back to the decision. Right now I’m more interested in how you got there.”
1:01–1:07	What happened? (slide 11)	What happened in the first few minutes? What did your function do first? What information did you have? What were you missing? When did you approach another function? What changed your view?
1:07–1:14	How did we work? (slide 12)	What made you share information? What made you hold information back? Did you ask before proposing? Where did assumptions appear? Did anyone challenge an assumption? Which risks only became visible later? Where did the conversation become “our function versus theirs”?
1:14–1:18	What was the impact? (slide 13)	What happened to the quality or speed of the decision? What happened when information arrived late? Where did assumptions replace conversations? Which dependencies became visible only when another function spoke?
1:18–1:20	Replay (slide 14)	“If you could replay those 20 minutes, what would you do differently?”

DEBRIEF MOVE

Ask participants to interpret the moment before explaining what it means. Use your observation sheet:

“At about minute six, Operations said a full launch would stretch capacity. The conversation moved on. What was happening there?”

Keep the focus on the system

Ask what made something hard, not who got it wrong. “What made it difficult for that information to land?” works; “Why didn’t you listen to Operations?” does not. If a single participant becomes the story, widen the lens: “Where else in the room did something similar happen?”

Capturing the replay

Write every answer to the replay question on a flipchart, in participants’ own words. Aim for eight to twelve behaviours. Do not reword them into framework language. During the break, cluster them into four unlabelled groups on the wall. If an item does not fit, leave it unclustered rather than forcing it.

The Framework: SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN

1:30–1:55

Framework

Slides 16–17 · Plenary · 25 min

Purpose. Give participants simple, memorable language for behaviours they have already identified.



How to introduce it

- **1:30–1:35.** Start from the clustered flipchart, not the slide. “Before the break you told me what you’d do differently. I’ve grouped what you said. What would you call this group?” Let the room name one or two clusters.
- **1:35–1:37.** Slide 16. Let the line land without commentary.
- **1:37–1:50.** Slide 17. Take each behaviour in turn, about three minutes each. Ask the room for a Round 1 moment first; offer one of your observed moments only if needed.
- **1:50–1:55.** Close the segment on ALIGN and on the idea that differences are useful. Take questions.

SAY

“These are four observable behaviours that strengthen cross-functional collaboration and working trust. You’ve already named most of them. This is simply a way to hold on to them.”

Behaviour	What it means	Prompt
SHARE	Make relevant information visible early.	What does another function need to know to make a better decision?
SEEK	Understand before assuming or proposing.	What might I be missing?
SURFACE	Make risks, constraints and disagreements discussable.	What needs to be made visible before we decide?
ALIGN	Turn different perspectives into a shared decision.	What are we collectively trying to achieve, and what trade-offs are we willing to own?

ON ALIGN

Alignment does not require agreement on everything. It requires enough shared understanding to make and own a decision together.

Language guardrails

Say	Avoid
"Four observable behaviours that strengthen cross-functional collaboration and working trust."	"These are the four components of trust."
"The experience creates opportunities to practise behaviours that can strengthen working trust."	"This workshop builds trust." / "You'll leave trusting one another."
"A simple naming of behaviours you've already identified."	Presenting the model as a formula or as scientifically proven.

1:55–2:05

Framework Practice

Slide 18 · Function groups · 10 min

Purpose. Make the framework specific to what happened in Round 1 before it is tested in Round 2.

Functions return to their areas and capture on their flipchart:

SHARE	One piece of information we should have made visible earlier.
SEEK	One question we should have asked another function.
SURFACE	One risk or disagreement that needed to be made more explicit.
ALIGN	One condition we would need to support the collective decision.

IF THE ROOM IS TOO EASY

Generic answers ("communicate earlier") mean the practice has not yet bitten. Expose an assumption rather than adding another activity: "Which piece of information, exactly? Who needed it? By when?"

Round 2 & Round 2 Debrief

2:05–2:25

Round 2

Slides 19–20 · One decision room · 20 min

Purpose. Genuine re-practice under changed conditions, with the framework in deliberate use.

- Bring everyone back into the decision space. Show slide 19 and read the event card (Appendix D) aloud. Give one printed card to each function.
- Show slide 20. Groups revisit the decision. They may keep or change their recommendation, and are explicitly asked to use SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN.
- Place the Round 2 Decision Sheet (Appendix E) in the centre. Start the 20-minute timer. Call time at 10, 5 and 1 minutes remaining.
- Use a fresh Observation Sheet. Look specifically for what is different from Round 1.

ROUND 2 EVENT CARD · READ ALOUD

A strategically important customer asks whether NexaFlow can be made available two weeks earlier because its own transformation programme has moved forward.

- Technology confirms that the high-volume performance issue can be managed through a controlled rollout.
- A full-scale launch still carries elevated technical risk.
- Operations can support a limited initial rollout but not projected full volume immediately.
- The customer is strategically important.

Groups answer: Recommendation · What are we protecting? · What are we compromising? · What risk are we accepting? · What needs to happen next?

FACILITATOR WATCH-FOR

The earlier date adds pressure. Watch whether it pulls functions back into their positions, or whether the group uses the new information to sharpen the trade-off. Either is useful in the debrief.

2:25–2:45

Round 2 Debrief

Slide 21 · Plenary · 20 min

Time	Movement	Questions
2:25–2:28	The decision on the record	Did the recommendation change? What new information changed or confirmed the view?
2:28–2:40	What was different this time?	SHARE: What did you make visible earlier? SEEK: What questions changed your understanding? SURFACE: What risk or disagreement became easier to discuss? ALIGN: What changed when you focused on the organisational decision rather than the position of your function?
2:40–2:45	The honest question	“Did using the framework guarantee agreement?”

INTENDED INSIGHT

No. The framework does not remove disagreement. It helps make disagreement more useful and supports better-informed collective decisions.

Let the room reach this. Name it yourself only if they do not.

If Round 2 went worse

It sometimes does, and it is still useful. Explore it rather than smoothing it over: “What made the behaviours harder under pressure?” That question is closer to real working life than a tidy success story.

Work Sample

Workplace Application

2:45–3:15

My Silo Moment

Slide 22 · Individual · 30 min

Purpose. Move from NexaTech to the participant's own work: one real cross-functional situation currently costing time, trust or performance.

2:45–2:50	Frame it. Hand out My Silo Moment (Appendix G). The situation must be one the participant is part of, not one they observe from the outside. Worksheets are personal and will not be collected.
2:50–3:10	Quiet individual work. At the halfway point, one prompt only: "Check your second answer. Is it what you are assuming, or what you think they are assuming?"
3:10–3:15	Form pairs for the Peer Exchange, across functions where possible and not within a reporting line. Decide who goes first.

Participants answer:

- What is happening?
- What am I assuming?
- What information is not being surfaced?
- Which behaviour is most needed?
- What conversation needs to happen?
- What action can I take?

DESIGN INTENT

The simulation gave leaders distance; this segment removes it. Keep the room quiet and unhurried. This is where the afternoon becomes useful to the business.

3:15–3:30

Peer Exchange

Slide 23 · Pairs · 15 min

Purpose. Reinforce SEEK by practising it on a real situation. The peer helps the participant see the situation more fully; they do not solve it.

Don't solve it. Help them see it.

2 min	The participant describes their situation.
4 min	The peer asks only these questions: What might you be assuming? What information might you be missing? What needs to be surfaced? What would alignment look like?
1 min	The participant writes one thing they see differently after the conversation.
Swap	Repeat with roles reversed.

With 25 participants there will be one trio. Give each person roughly five minutes and let the two listeners share the questions.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Listen for peers who start solving. Interrupt lightly: “Hold the solution. Ask one more question.” Senior managers are good at solving; this is deliberate practice in not doing so.

Work Sample

Commitment & Close

3:30–3:40

Commitment

Slide 24 · Individual → plenary
· 10 min

Purpose. Leave with one specific, observable behavioural change.

- **3:30–3:35.** Participants complete the Commitment Card (Appendix I): “In my next cross-functional interaction, I will...”, tick the behaviour it practises, and complete “I will know I have done it when...” and “When will I start?”
- **3:35–3:38.** Specificity test with their Peer Exchange partner: “Could someone watching you notice it happen?” If not, sharpen it.
- **3:38–3:40.** Invite three or four volunteers to read theirs aloud. Do not evaluate; thank them.

Specific and observable	Too vague to act on
Ask two questions before proposing a solution.	Collaborate better.
Surface a delivery risk earlier.	Communicate more.
Share a constraint before it becomes a blocker.	Build trust.
End a cross-functional discussion by confirming the shared outcome and next action.	

Cards belong to the participants. If the organisation has chosen the optional 30-day check-in (Section 16), suggest participants photograph their card.

3:40–3:45

Close

Slide 25 · Plenary · 5 min

Return briefly to the opening question from slide 2, then close with these lines, word for word. End on the final line. No summary slide, no further instructions afterwards.

SAY

“Cross-functional collaboration doesn’t require everyone to think the same way. It requires us to make enough of the picture visible for different perspectives to become a better collective decision.”

“The goal isn’t fewer perspectives. It’s a better shared picture.”

Facilitator Preparation & Room Setup

Before the day

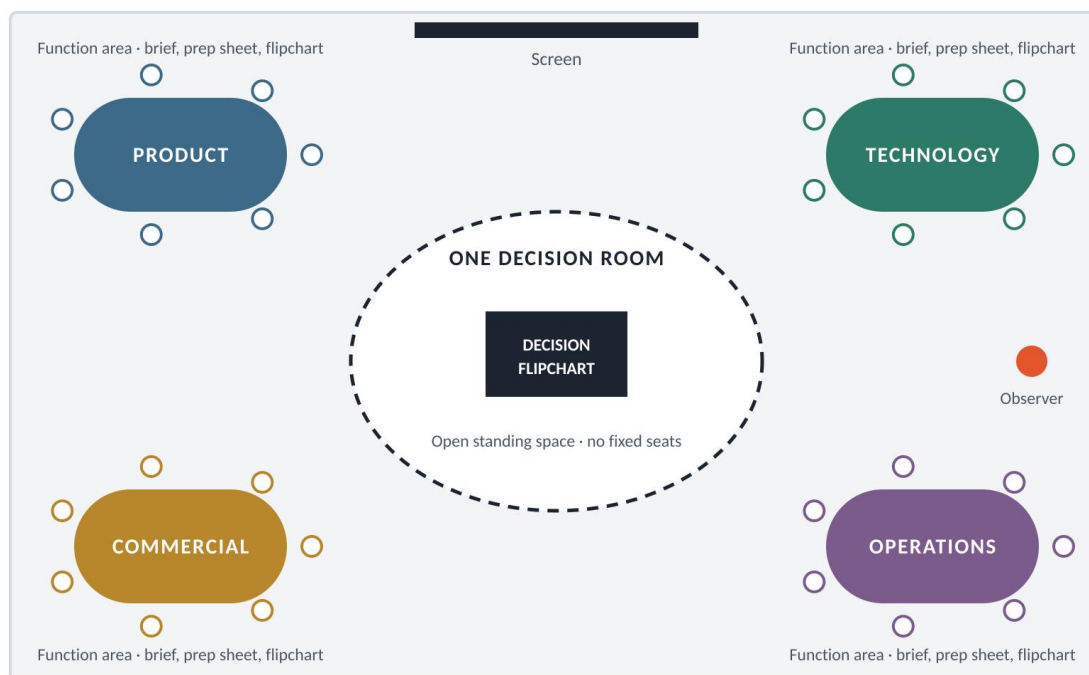
- Obtain the participant list and assign the four groups (6 · 6 · 6 · 7). Where the list allows, place people outside their home function and spread senior reporting lines across groups.
- Read all four function briefs until you can hold the whole picture without notes. Study the dependency threads and tension map in Section 07.
- Rehearse the opening question, the role statement and the closing lines word for word.
- Brief the co-facilitator, if there is one: timekeeping, observation, and taking the replay flipchart during the break.
- Print all materials (quantities below).

Materials

Item	Quantity	Appendix	First used
Four labelled function areas (table signs in function colour)	4	—	Set-up
Common Participant Brief	25 + 3 spare	A	0:20
Function Briefs	7 per function	A.1–A.4	0:30
Function Preparation Sheets	1 per function + 4 spare	B	0:30
Round 1 Decision Sheet	2 × A3 + flipchart version	C	0:38
Round 2 Event Card	4 + 1 facilitator copy	D	2:05
Round 2 Decision Sheet	2 × A3 + flipchart version	E	2:05
SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN reference	25	F	1:30
My Silo Moment worksheets	25	G	2:45
Peer Exchange prompts	25	H	3:15
Commitment Cards (two per A4, cut)	25	I	3:30
Facilitator Observation Sheet	4 (two per round)	J	0:38
Timer visible to the whole room	1	—	0:30
Projector / screen	1	—	0:00
Flipcharts / whiteboard	6 (four function, one decision, one replay)	—	0:10
Markers and sticky notes	As useful	—	—

Room setup

Create four functional preparation areas, one in each corner, and keep the centre of the room open as one shared decision space. The physical movement from the corners into the centre is the story of the session: **four perspectives → one decision room**.



- Keep the centre free of tables so people stand and move. Place the decision flipchart at its heart.
- Make sure the screen and timer are visible from the centre.
- Position the observer at the edge with a clear sightline to all four functions.
- Pre-write the replay flipchart heading: "If we replayed those 20 minutes..."
- Arrive at least 45 minutes early to set the room and test the screen.

Facilitation Contingencies

Productive friction is part of the experience. Do not immediately rescue the group. Use these only once the room has had a genuine chance to work it out.

If...	Ask or say
Participants immediately seek consensus	“What information are you still missing?”
One function dominates	To another function: “What does your perspective add that we haven’t considered?”
Participants become defensive	“What business outcome is each function trying to protect?”
Participants ask for the correct answer	“There isn’t one predetermined answer. I’m interested in the quality of the decision, the trade-off you chose and whether you can collectively own the risk.”
Participants finish too quickly	“What assumption is your decision relying on?”
Participants cannot reach agreement	“What would you need to know to make this decision together?”
Someone questions the realism of the scenario	Agree that it is simplified, then ask: “What would make it more like your world?” Note the answer; it is useful for My Silo Moment.
The Round 1 Debrief runs long	Protect the replay question above everything else. Shorten “What was the impact?” to one question.

DO NOT RESCUE

A stalled room is usually close to its most useful moment. Wait. When you do intervene, ask a question; never supply the missing information yourself.

Measurement & Success Indicators

Trust cannot be measured at the end of an afternoon, and the session does not claim to change behaviour on its own. What can be observed is whether participants practised the behaviours, recognised them in their own work and made a usable commitment.

When	What to look for
During the experience	Quality of information sharing · quality of questioning · risks surfaced · assumptions challenged · dependencies recognised · collective decision ownership. Compare Round 1 with Round 2 using the Observation Sheets.
At the end	Ability to identify a real workplace silo · ability to identify the missing behaviour · specificity of the behavioural commitment.
Optional follow-up	A lightweight 30-day check-in, if the organisation wants to examine whether participants experimented with their selected behaviour. Three questions are enough: Which behaviour did you try? What happened? What got in the way?

Report what was observed, in plain terms. Do not report trust scores or claim guaranteed behaviour change.

The Launch Decision

One business. Four perspectives. One decision.

The situation

NexaTech is preparing to launch **NexaFlow**, a new technology solution designed to help large organisations manage and automate high-volume internal processes.

The launch is scheduled six weeks from now.	NexaFlow is strategically important to NexaTech.
Significant investment has already been made.	Early customer interest is strong.
The project is officially considered on track.	Different functions see different readiness signals.

Your task

As NexaTech's leadership group, make **one collective recommendation**:

☐ Launch as planned ☐ Phase the launch ☐ Reduce initial scope ☐ Delay the launch

And be ready to explain:

- What are we protecting?
- What are we willing to compromise?
- What is the biggest risk we are accepting?
- What needs to happen next?

Four perspectives

PRODUCT	TECHNOLOGY	COMMERCIAL	OPERATIONS
Customer value and proposition	Technical readiness and reliability	Customer confidence and market opportunity	Implementation and support capacity

REMEMBER

Each function has part of the picture. No function has all of it.

There is no predetermined correct answer.

For this simulation, you are temporarily representing a functional perspective. You are not expected to behave according to your actual job function.

Function Preparation: 8 minutes · Round 1: 20 minutes

PRODUCT

Customer value and proposition

Product is responsible for ensuring NexaFlow solves a meaningful customer problem and delivers a strong value proposition.

What you know

- Customer research shows that two capabilities are particularly important to early customers.
- These capabilities are central to how those customers understand the product's value.
- Both capabilities are planned for the initial launch.
- Reducing initial scope would simplify delivery.
- Significantly limiting these capabilities could weaken the proposition for the customers currently showing the strongest interest.

What concerns you

A launch that happens quickly but does not deliver the experience customers expect.

YOU ARE PROTECTING

Customer value and the credibility of the product proposition.

You need clarity on

- What can realistically be delivered.
- Technical and operational implications.
- What a phased or reduced launch means for customers.
- What commitments the organisation can confidently support.

Prepare with your function using the Function Preparation Sheet. You have 8 minutes.

TECHNOLOGY

Technical readiness and reliability

Technology is responsible for ensuring NexaFlow is reliable, stable and technically ready.

What you know

- The project is officially on track.
- Testing has identified a performance issue at high volumes.
- The issue is manageable.
- A full technical fix requires additional development time.
- A controlled rollout lowers exposure.
- A full-scale launch creates greater technical risk before the complete fix is available.

What concerns you

Reliability and customer experience after launch.

YOU ARE PROTECTING

Reliability and technical readiness.

You need clarity on

- Expected customer volume.
- Rollout pattern.
- Whether controlled rollout is commercially acceptable.
- What level of risk the organisation is prepared to accept.

Prepare with your function using the Function Preparation Sheet. You have 8 minutes.

COMMERCIAL

Customer confidence and market opportunity

Commercial is responsible for customer confidence, market momentum and the business opportunity.

What you know

- Early enterprise customer interest is strong.
- One strategically important customer is planning its own transformation programme around expected availability.
- There is no formal contractual commitment to an exact launch date.
- Expectations have nevertheless been established.
- A significant delay could affect customer confidence and commercial momentum.
- A poor customer experience could also damage confidence.

What concerns you

Losing customer confidence, whether through a significant delay or a poor customer experience.

YOU ARE PROTECTING

Customer confidence, market momentum and commercial opportunity.

You need clarity on

- What “ready” means across the organisation.
- Whether staged introduction is commercially workable.
- What customers would experience under different options.
- Which risks can be actively managed.

Prepare with your function using the Function Preparation Sheet. You have 8 minutes.

OPERATIONS

Implementation and support capacity

Operations is responsible for implementation, support and organisational readiness.

What you know

- A controlled initial rollout is manageable.
- Projected full launch volume would stretch implementation and support capacity.
- Additional capacity can be created but cannot be added instantly.
- A larger launch would increase pressure on implementation and support teams.
- A phased approach would provide time to build capacity and learn from early implementations.

What concerns you

Pressure on implementation and support teams, and the quality of implementation that follows.

YOU ARE PROTECTING

Implementation quality, support capacity and organisational readiness.

You need clarity on

- Likely initial customer volume.
- Rollout pattern.
- Customer support expectations.
- Risks the organisation is prepared to accept.

Prepare with your function using the Function Preparation Sheet. You have 8 minutes.

Function Preparation Sheet

Eight minutes. Build your function's view before you enter the decision room.

☐ Product ☐ Technology ☐ Commercial ☐ Operations

What is our function responsible for?

What are we protecting?

What concerns us most?

What information do we have that others may need?

What do we need to understand from the other functions?

What would we initially recommend?

Work Sample

Round 1 Decision Sheet

One collective recommendation. Twenty minutes.

Our recommendation

- ☐ Launch as planned ☐ Phase the launch ☐ Reduce initial scope ☐ Delay the launch

What are we protecting?	What are we willing to compromise?
What is the biggest risk we are accepting?	What needs to happen next?

BEFORE YOU COMMIT

- ☐ Have we heard all four perspectives?
- ☐ Have we surfaced the most important risks?
- ☐ Are we making assumptions we have not checked?
- ☐ Can all four functions explain why this is a decision the organisation can own?

Round 2 Event Card

ROUND 2 · NEW INFORMATION

A strategically important customer asks whether NexaFlow can be made available two weeks earlier because its own transformation programme has moved forward.

- Technology confirms that the high-volume performance issue can be managed through a controlled rollout.
- A full-scale launch still carries elevated technical risk.
- Operations can support a limited initial rollout but not projected full volume immediately.
- The customer is strategically important.

Revisit your decision. You may keep or change your recommendation. This time, use SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN deliberately.

You have 20 minutes. Record your decision on the Round 2 Decision Sheet.

Round 2 Decision Sheet

Same decision. New conditions. Twenty minutes.

Our recommendation

☐ Launch as planned ☐ Phase the launch ☐ Reduce initial scope ☐ Delay the launch

Did our recommendation change? ☐ Yes ☐ No

What new information changed or confirmed our view?

How we used the framework

SHARE

What did we make visible early?

SEEK

What did we ask to understand?

SURFACE

What risk or disagreement did we make explicit?

ALIGN

What shared outcome are we deciding for?

What are we protecting?

What are we compromising?

What risk are we accepting?

What needs to happen next?

SHARE → SEEK → SURFACE → ALIGN

Four observable behaviours that strengthen cross-functional collaboration and working trust.



	What it means	Ask yourself
SHARE	Make relevant information visible early.	<i>What does another function need to know to make a better decision?</i>
SEEK	Understand before assuming or proposing.	<i>What might I be missing?</i>
SURFACE	Make risks, constraints and disagreements discussable.	<i>What needs to be made visible before we decide?</i>
ALIGN	Turn different perspectives into a shared decision.	<i>What are we collectively trying to achieve, and what trade-offs are we willing to own?</i>

ALIGNMENT IS NOT AGREEMENT

Alignment does not require agreement on everything. It requires enough shared understanding to make and own a decision together.

Different perspectives are not the problem. A fragmented picture is.

My Silo Moment

One real cross-functional situation. Yours to keep.

The situation

Choose a cross-functional situation you are part of that is currently costing time, trust or performance.

It is costing: ☐ Time ☐ Trust ☐ Performance

What happens today?

What might I be assuming?

What information is not being surfaced?

Which behaviour is most needed?

☐ SHARE ☐ SEEK ☐ SURFACE ☐ ALIGN

What conversation needs to happen?

With whom?

What is one action I can take?

Don't solve it. Help them see it.

Peer Exchange

2 min	Your partner describes their silo moment.
4 min	You ask only the questions below. Resist offering solutions.
1 min	Your partner notes one thing they see differently.
Swap	Change roles and repeat.

Questions to ask

- 1 What might you be assuming?
- 2 What information might you be missing?
- 3 What needs to be surfaced?
- 4 What would alignment look like?

One thing I see differently after the conversation

COMMITMENT CARD

In my next cross-functional interaction, I will...

This practises: ☐ SHARE ☐ SEEK ☐ SURFACE ☐ ALIGN

I will know I have done it when...

When will I start? _____



COMMITMENT CARD

In my next cross-functional interaction, I will...

This practises: ☐ SHARE ☐ SEEK ☐ SURFACE ☐ ALIGN

I will know I have done it when...

When will I start? _____

Facilitator Observation Sheet

Round: ☐ 1 ☐ 2

Observer: _____

Start time: _____

Observe the system, not individual personalities. Record words and moments, not judgements. This is not a participant scorecard.

Behaviour	Evidence / moment (time · words · who)
SHARE Relevant information offered proactively	
SEEK Questions used to understand	
SURFACE Risks, constraints or disagreement made visible	
ALIGN Group moves toward a shared outcome	
Assumptions Identified or challenged	
Dependencies Recognised between functions	
Functional advocacy Positions argued, and on what basis	
Enterprise thinking "The organisation needs..."	

Behaviour	Evidence / moment (time · words · who)
Decision ownership Collective ownership of the decision and its risk	

Work Sample

Three moments for the debrief

Choose moments the room will recognise. In the debrief, describe the moment and ask the group to interpret it before you say what you think it means.

	Time	What happened (words, not judgements)	Question I will ask
Moment 1			
Moment 2			
Moment 3			

Round 1 → Round 2: what changed in how the system worked?

DESIGN NOTE

Design basis. The experience draws on principles from experiential learning, simulation-based learning and cross-functional collaboration research. The design intentionally combines realistic challenge, distributed perspectives, facilitated reflection, behavioural framing, immediate re-practice and workplace transfer.